

GREAT HAUL OF CHINA

Game	G	S	B	T
Gymnastics	9	2	4	15
Diving	7	1	3	11
Weightlifting	8	1		9
Shooting	5	2	1	8
Kayak Flatwater	1			1
Badminton	3	2	3	8
Swimming	1	3	3	7
Table Tennis	4	2	2	8
Judo	3		1	4
Archery	1	1	1	3
Trampoline	2		1	3
Wrestling	1	2		3
Athletics			2	2
Beach Volleyball		1	1	2
Fencing	1	1		2
Rowing	1	1		2
Sailing	1		1	2
Taekwondo	1		1	2
Boxing	2	1	1	4
Volleyball			1	1
Cycle-Track			1	1
Hockey		1		1
Tennis			1	1
Total	51	21	28	100



Zhong Man :
Celebrates his
victory during the
men's individual
sabre fencing final
at the Beijing
Olympic Games



Silver Glory: The women's
4x200-metre freestyle relay team of
China pose with their silver medals



Magic Sticks:
Chinese players
celebrate a goal during
the women's hockey
semi-final match
against Germany.
China eventually
won the silver medal
at Beijing Olympics.
It's the country's
first-ever hockey
medal in
the Games.



AFP PHOTO:INDRANIL MUKHERJEE

THE CHINESE GOVERNMENT KNOWS THAT SPORT IS A QUASI-DIPLOMATIC TOOL AND THE IDEAL NON-THREATENING ADVERTISEMENT FOR ITS GROWING GLOBAL POWER.

estimated that the cost of preparing China's athletes for Beijing 2008 was close to \$586 million. That would make it more than \$11 million spent for every gold, or \$5.86 million for every Beijing medal. According to the General Administration of Sport, the funds towards preparing athletes have come from two major sources annually: a budget allocation of 800 million RMB (Rs 507 crore) and an equal amount from the National Lottery given to the National Olympics Committee. Interestingly, India's sports budget for 2008-09 stands at Rs 1,111 crore.

After the 2004 Athens Olympics when China finished second behind the United States with 32 gold, there was an awareness that a sporting giant from the East was about to rise, specially as it was the 2008 Games host. Chinese officials continued to play coy, denying that toppling the US was the goal for Beijing. Instead the catch phrase was that China wanted to head the "second leadership group" i.e. compete with Russia and Germany.

What was being devised in the background instead was a systematic plan to identify sports that yielded more

gold medals than single-medal disciplines and to create a sustained programme for Chinese success around them. This was referred to as Project 119, around the 119 gold medals to be won in track and field, swimming, canoeing/kayaking, rowing and sailing. The Chinese establishment has denied the existence of such a project of any kind; but after winning its Olympic bid beefed up its top national training bases around the country. It pumped in \$291million into its high altitude training base in Duoba in the north-west and put in an extra \$10 million behind